BIG DUMB ROBOT · GUIDE · VERSION 1.0

Conductor

Your multichannel interface, working on modern macOS, with a full control room on screen: monitoring, two headphone mixes, routing, profiles and a remote for your phone.



Conductor 1.0 · macOS 14 Sonoma or later · Apple silicon and Intel

From Canada with love

GETTING STARTED

Install

One installer puts in the app and a small background service. No Terminal, nothing to build.

What you need

Your interface connected by USB and switched on, and a Mac with macOS 14 (Sonoma) or later, Apple silicon or Intel.

Install

1. Double-click **Conductor-1.0.0.pkg**.
2. Click **Continue**, then **Install**, and enter your Mac password when asked.
3. When it finishes, Conductor opens by itself. The interface's front-panel **!** clears within a few seconds and the app shows **Connected** at the bottom left.

> **If macOS says it can't open the installer** ("Apple could not verify…"): click **Done**, open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**, scroll down to the message about Conductor and click **Open Anyway**, then enter your password. Double-click the installer again.

The first time it runs

- **Record audio from other apps:** allow it. Conductor measures what your Mac plays, so the main and headphone meters move.
- **Find devices on your local network:** asked when you open Phone Remote. Allow it so your phone can connect.
- **Background Items Added:** that's Conductor's service. Leave it switched on in System Settings → General → Login Items.

What gets installed

PART	WHAT IT DOES
Conductor	The app in your Applications folder, plus the monitor panel in the menu bar.
Background service	Wakes the interface, keeps its settings and puts them back if it forgets (it does after a power cycle). Starts by itself at login.

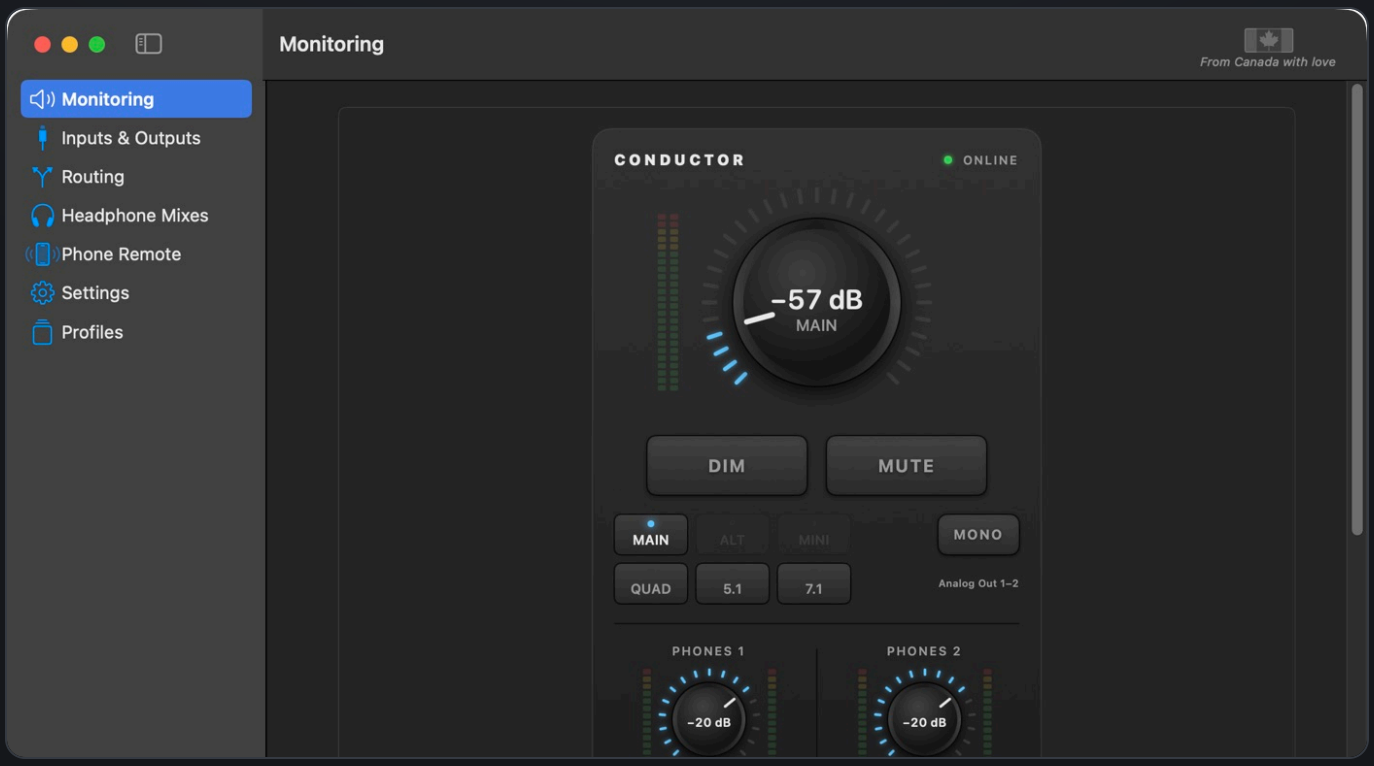
Update or remove

Update: run a newer installer. Your settings and profiles stay.

Remove: in Conductor choose **Conductor** → **Uninstall Conductor…**. Profiles and settings are kept for next time.

Monitoring

A monitor controller on screen: one big knob, big DIM and MUTE, speaker sets and both headphone outputs. The same panel lives in the menu bar, so you rarely need the full window.



The Monitoring page.

Main output

- **Big knob:** main monitor level. Drag up or down. The ring turns amber while DIM is on.
- DIM drops the level for talkback or a phone call; MUTE silences the speakers.
- MAIN ALT MINI switch stereo speaker pairs; QUAD 5.1 7.1 switch to surround; MONO folds to mono.

Menu bar

Click the speaker icon in the menu bar for the same panel, plus profiles, the Mac volume keys switch (the keyboard's volume keys set the main level while the interface is the Mac's sound output) and Open at login.

Phones 1 and 2

- **Small knob:** headphone level, with DIM and MUTE for each.
- BUS A / BUS B send one of the two headphone mixes.
- The menu under the buttons offers any other feed: mirror an output pair, or any DAW or input pair.

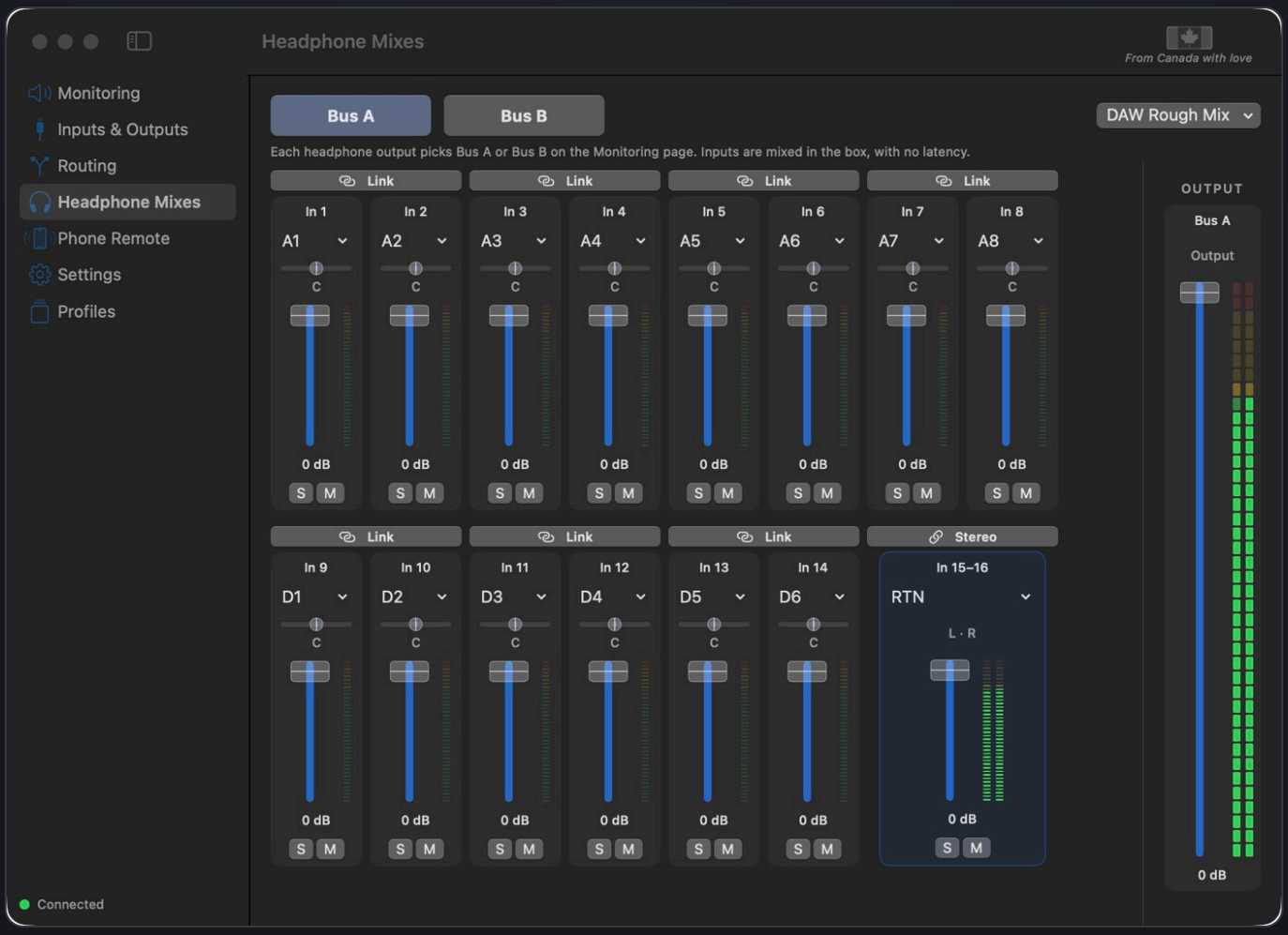
Speakers

MAIN is any stereo pair; ALT and MINI any other pair, or Off. QUAD plays fronts on Analog Out 1–2 and rears on 7–8, 5.1 on Out 1–6 (L R C LFE Ls Rs), 7.1 on Out 1–8. Each set remembers its own level. Keep line-level sends on outputs above the ones the knob controls.

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Headphone Mixes

Two separate stereo cue mixes, Bus A and Bus B, mixed inside the interface. Inputs reach the headphones with zero latency, because they never go through the Mac.



Bus A: inputs 1–8 above 9–16 (A = analog, D = digital/optical), the DAW rough mix linked on 15–16 (RTN), and the bus output on the right.

Build a cue mix

1. Click **Bus A** or **Bus B** at the top.
2. On each strip, pick the source: an input or a DAW channel.
3. Set fader and pan. **Option-click** a fader for 0 dB or a pan to centre it; **Command-click** a fader to take it all the way down.
4. Use S solo and M mute per strip; **Option-click** either to clear every solo or mute in the bus. The **Output** fader on the right is the bus's master level.
5. On the Monitoring page, set each headphone output to **BUS A** or **BUS B**.

Stereo pairs

Click **Link** above two inputs (1–2, 3–4 … 15–16) to make them one stereo strip: pick a stereo source (a keyboard, a DAW pair, an optical pair) and one fader, solo and mute move both sides, panned left and right. Click **Stereo** to split it again. Links are saved in profiles.

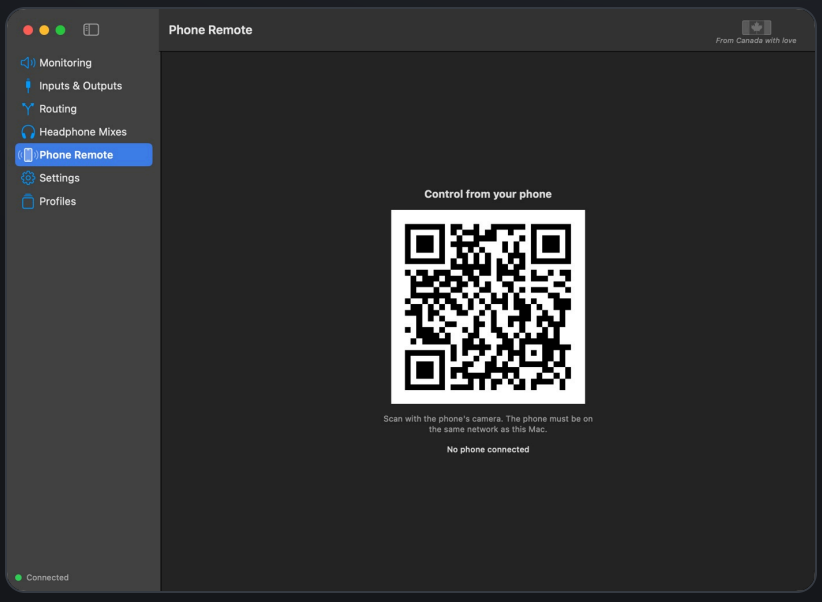
DAW Rough Mix

Performers usually want the track too. **DAW Rough Mix** (top right) puts a DAW output pair on inputs 15–16 as a stereo pair, labelled RTN. Send your session's rough mix to that pair in the DAW, and the performer hears it alongside their zero-latency inputs.

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Phone Remote

Your phone becomes the monitor controller: main level, DIM, MUTE, speaker sets, mono and both headphone outputs. Handy at the desk, the couch or in the live room.



The Phone Remote page in Conductor.



On the phone. Drag a knob up or down.

Connect a phone

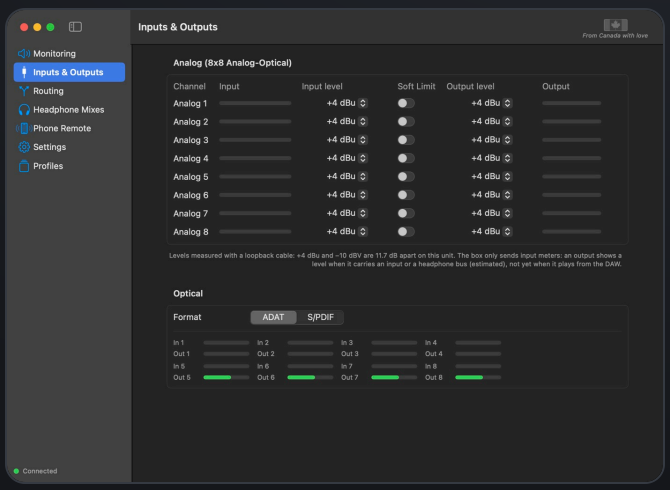
1. Put the phone on the **same Wi-Fi network** as the Mac.
2. In Conductor, open **Phone Remote**.
3. Point the phone's camera at the QR code and tap the link that appears.
4. Add it to the home screen (Share → Add to Home Screen) to open it like an app next time.

Several phones can connect at once. The page counts them under the QR code.

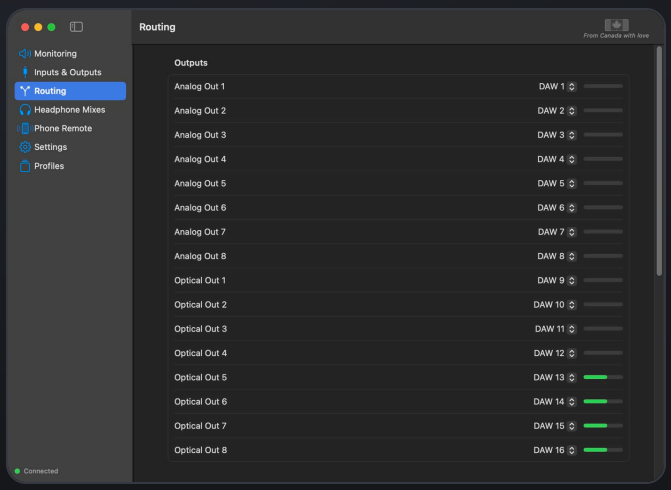
Private to your network. The QR code holds a private key, so only phones that scanned it can connect, and only from your local network. The address in the code is your Mac's local network address (it starts with 192.168 on most home and studio networks) and updates by itself if the Mac changes networks.

The phone can't connect? Check it's on the same network as the Mac (not mobile data or a guest network), that you allowed Conductor to find devices on your local network (System Settings → Privacy & Security → Local Network), and that the Mac's firewall lets Conductor accept incoming connections.

Inputs, Outputs and Routing



Inputs & Outputs.



Routing.

Inputs & Outputs

- **Input level / Output level:** +4 dBu (pro) or −10 dBV (consumer) for each analog channel. They measure 11.7 dB apart.
- **Soft Limit:** the analog soft clipper on each input.
- **Optical:** ADAT or S/PDIF.
- Meters for every input and output. An output shows a level when it carries an input, a headphone bus or what the Mac plays.

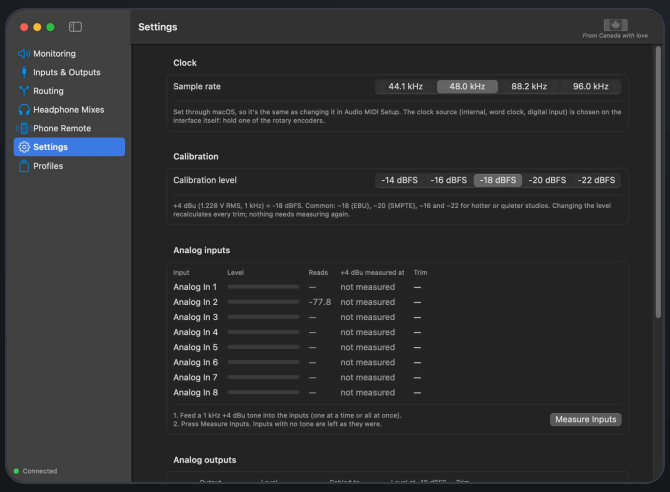
Routing

- **Outputs:** choose what each analog and optical output plays: a DAW channel, an input (direct, zero latency), or Bus A / Bus B.
- **Recording channels:** choose what each of the 16 channels the Mac records carries. Usually Analog In 1–8 and Optical In 1–8; a headphone bus can be recorded too.

Conductor saves everything and puts it back if the interface forgets its settings, which it does when it's switched off and on.

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Settings and Calibration



Clock at the top, calibration below.

Clock

Sample rate: 44.1, 48, 88.2 or 96 kHz (the same setting as Audio MIDI Setup). The clock source (internal, word clock, digital input) is chosen on the interface itself: hold one of its rotary encoders.

Calibration level

Choose what +4 dBu (1.228 V RMS) reads in your DAW: –18 dBFS (EBU), –20 (SMPTE), or –14, –16, –22.

1. Measure the inputs

1. Feed a 1 kHz tone at +4 dBu into the analog inputs, one at a time or all at once.
2. Click **Measure Inputs**. Inputs with a steady tone are measured; the others are left as they were.

2. Measure the outputs (automatic)

1. Patch each output you want to measure into an input you've already measured, and choose that input under **Cabled to**.
2. Tick those outputs and click **Calibrate Outputs**. Conductor plays the tone, routes it, measures it, and puts your routing back.

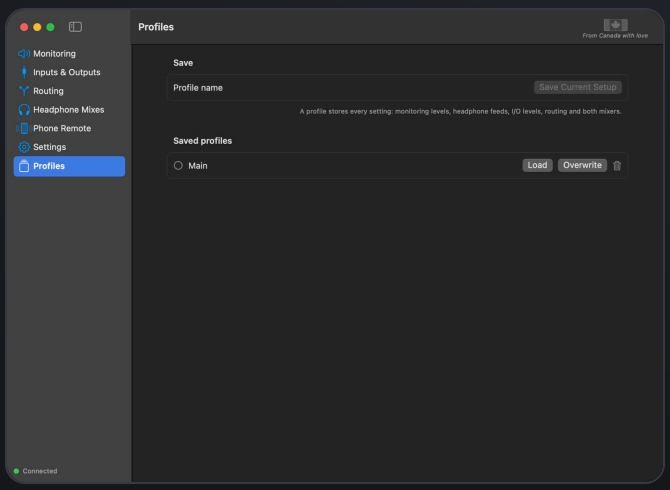
> Outputs 1–2 usually feed your speakers, so they start unticked. Turn the speakers down before measuring them.

> The interface has no fine trim of its own: its only level setting is +4 dBu / –10 dBV. Conductor measures each channel and shows the trim it needs. Applying trims live comes with the **Servo** upgrade.

If you change a channel's +4 dBu / –10 dBV setting, measure it again: a warning sign shows which ones. Optical channels are digital and need no calibration.

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Profiles and Help



Profiles.

Profiles

A profile stores every setting: monitoring, headphone feeds, I/O levels, routing and both headphone mixes. Type a name and click **Save Current Setup**; **Load**, **Overwrite** or delete them later. Load one quickly from the menu bar panel.

The guide

In Conductor: **Help** → **Conductor Guide**.

Troubleshooting

YOU SEE	TRY
The interface's ! stays on	Check the USB cable and power. Conductor should say **Connected** at the bottom left.
"Interface not connected"	Switch the interface off and on again. After restarting the Mac with the interface left on, it sometimes needs this before the Mac sees it.
"Background service isn't running"	Check System Settings → General → Login Items: Conductor must be switched on. Then restart the Mac, or run the installer again.
No sound in the DAW	Choose the interface as the DAW's audio device. On the Routing page, outputs should play DAW channels.
Main and headphone meters don't move	Allow Conductor to record audio from other apps: System Settings → Privacy & Security → Screen & System Audio Recording.
No speaker icon in the menu bar	It may be hidden behind the camera notch when the menu bar is full.
Settings changed after a power cycle	Wait a few seconds: Conductor puts them back.

For support: the background service keeps a log at `~/Library/Logs/Conductor.log`. Settings and profiles live in `~/Library/Application Support/Conductor`. Include the log when you report a problem.

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Stream Deck (Companion)

Put monitoring on a Stream Deck with Bitfocus Companion: dials for the main and headphone levels, keys for mute, dim, mono, speaker sets and headphone mixes. Keys light up when they're on.

Set it up

1. Install **Bitfocus Companion** (free, bitfocus.io) on the Mac running Conductor.
2. In Companion, open **Modules** → **Import module package** and choose **Conductor for Companion.tgz** from the Conductor download.
3. In **Connections**, add **Conductor**. Leave the address at `127.0.0.1` and the port at `7100`.
4. Open **Presets** → **Conductor** and drag what you want onto your Stream Deck.

> **Speaker sets** (MAIN, ALT, MINI, QUAD, 5.1, 7.1) are switched by the Conductor app, so keep it open (it can sit in the menu bar).

The presets

GROUP	WHAT IT DOES
Dials	Main, Phones 1, Phones 2 on a Stream Deck + dial: turn for level (1 dB a click), press to mute. The label shows the level.
Monitoring	MUTE DIM MONO for the main speakers.
Speakers	MAIN, ALT, MINI, QUAD, 5.1, 7.1. The playing set lights up.
Headphones	Bus A or Bus B for each headphone output.

On a Stream Deck without dials, use the **Level: turn up or down** action on two keys (step 1 and –1), or **Level: set** for fixed levels.